The AI Builder Starter Stack

From Hotfix Daily, the free weekday AI builder digest · hotfixdaily.com · Last reviewed October 21, 2026

THE STACK, LAYER BY LAYER

1. A coding agent

Pick one editor agent and one terminal agent. Compare options →

- Cursor
- GitHub Copilot
- Claude Code
- Codex CLI
- Gemini CLI (open source)

2. A browser app builder (for prototypes)

For a quick demo, or if you don't code yet. Compare options →

- Lovable
- Bolt
- v0
- Replit

3. Model access

One API key for many models, or run open models on your machine.

- OpenRouter (one API, many models)
- Ollama (local models)
- Hugging Face (open models)

4. Agent plumbing

Shared instructions and tool connections.

- AGENTS.md (instructions file)
- Model Context Protocol (MCP)

5. Ship it

Free or cheap hosting and a database.

- GitHub Pages (static sites)
- Vercel
- Netlify
- Supabase (Postgres, auth, storage)

6. Talk to users

An email list you own.

- Kit (newsletter, what we use)

7. If you make games

Engine agents and asset tools. Compare options →

- Unity's AI tools + MCP
- Roblox Assistant
- Scenario
- Meshy
- ElevenLabs (voice)

THE 5 RULES FOR SHIPPING WITH AGENTS

1. **Write the rules once.** Put build, test and style commands in AGENTS.md (or CLAUDE.md) so every agent follows them. Source
2. **Checkpoint before every task.** Commit before and after each agent task so any change can be undone. Source
3. **No proof, no merge.** The agent runs tests or the build and shows the output before it says "done". Source
4. **Fresh eyes on every diff.** Have a second, fresh-context session review the change. Source
5. **Secrets stay secret.** Keep API keys out of front-end code and chat prompts; use environment variables.

No tool paid to be listed. Tools change fast: get what changed every weekday at **hotfixdaily.com** · Full guides: hotfixdaily.com/guides/